

Macanao Cacao

Venezuelan fine-flavor cacao, named for Macanao, Margarita Island's wild western peninsula.

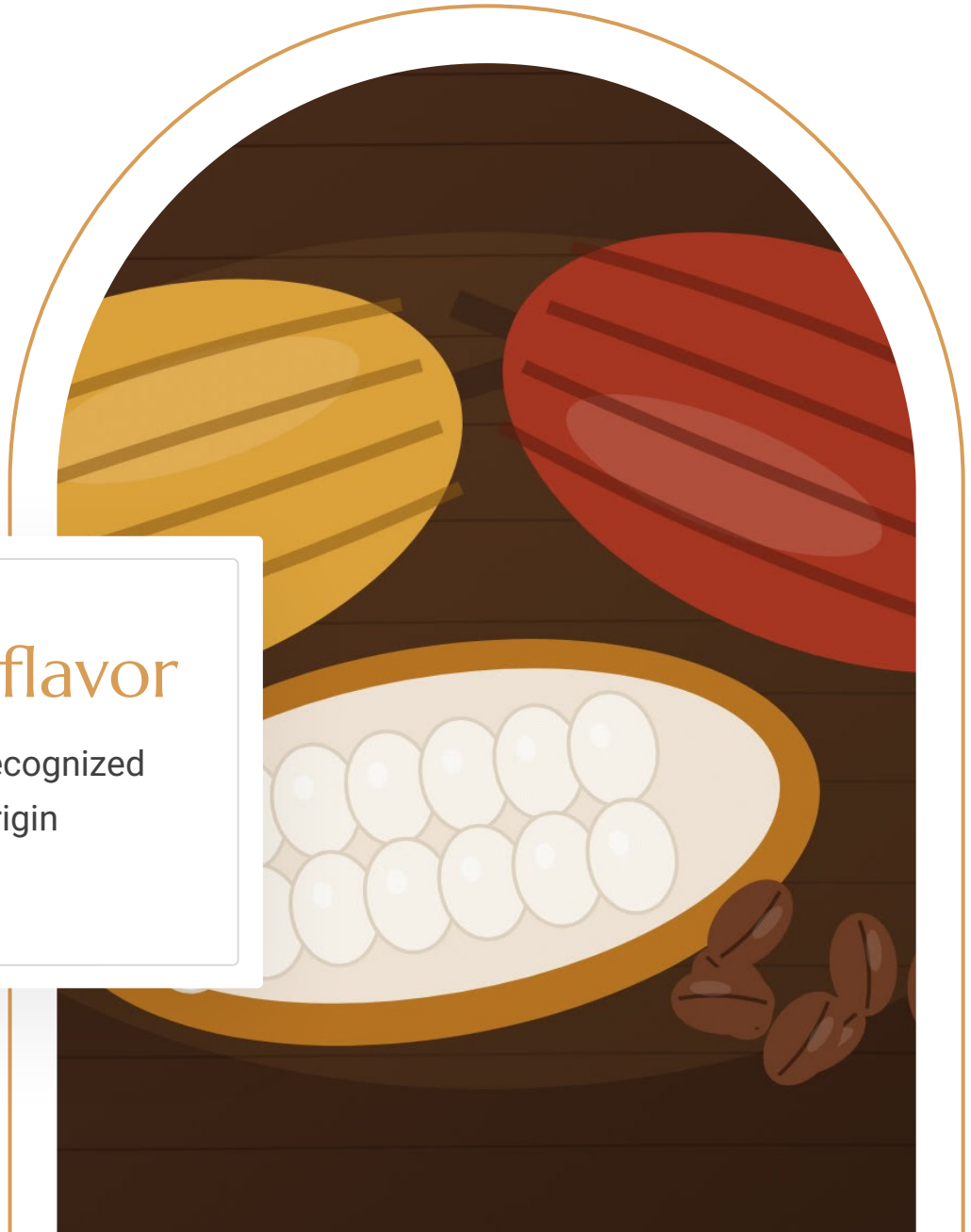
For craft chocolate makers · 2026

WHY VENEZUELAN CACAO

A heritage of Criollo cacao

Venezuela is historically a source of prized Criollo and Trinitario cacao, and the International Cocoa Organization (ICCO) recognizes it as a fine-flavor cacao producer.

Origins such as Paria / Río Caribe, Barlovento and Sur del Lago are known names among craft chocolate makers.



Fine flavor

ICCO-recognized origin

THE GAP

Venezuelan beans are hard to source

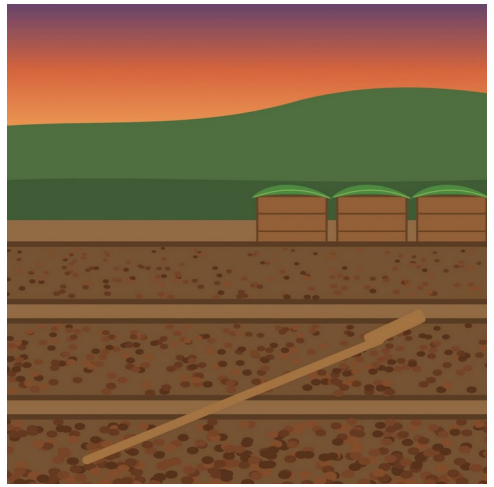
Cocoa-bean exports to the US: about US$19M in 2025, up from near zero in 2024 (USDA)

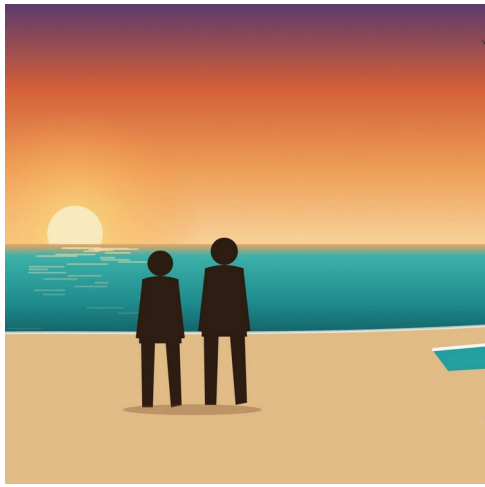
Sanctions-era uncertainty, small-lot logistics and verification make sourcing hard for US craft makers.

Escazú Artisan Chocolates (Raleigh, NC) has said publicly that importing Venezuelan beans is difficult.

The opportunity: a trusted, traceable channel.













WHO WE ARE

Una familia, dos orillas.



Daniel

Gainesville, Florida

Works with US craft chocolate makers and handles import and compliance.



Daniel's father

Margarita Island, Venezuela

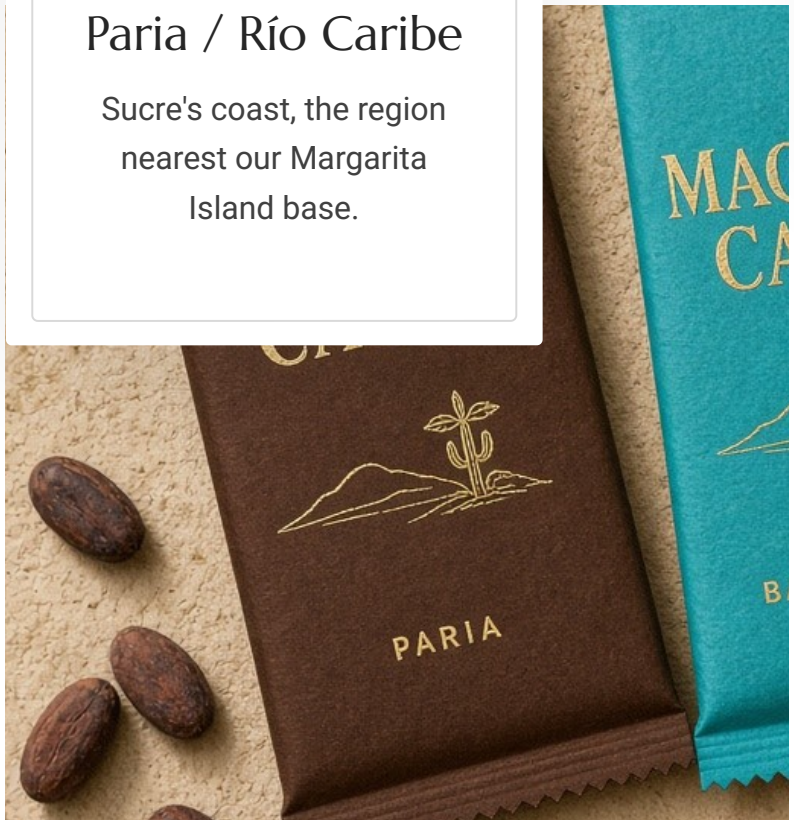
Vets suppliers, runs quality checks and keeps the books on the ground. Retired accountant and former audit partner at Deloitte LatAm.

ORIGINS

Three Venezuelan origins

Paria / Río Caribe

Sucre's coast, the region nearest our Margarita Island base.



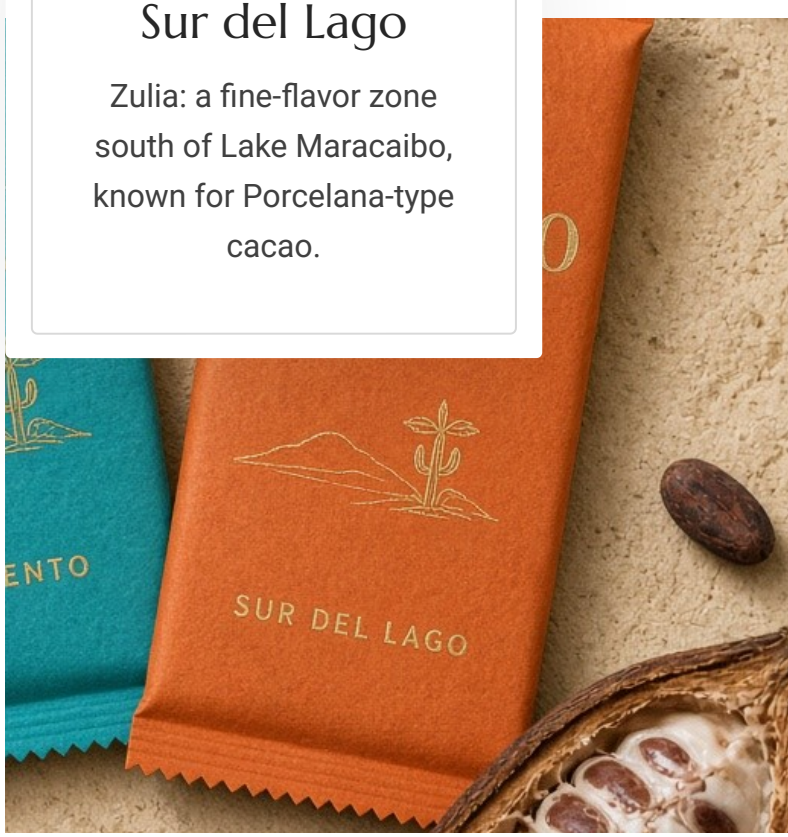
Barlovento

Miranda: a historic cacao zone east of Caracas.



Sur del Lago

Zulia: a fine-flavor zone south of Lake Maracaibo, known for Porcelana-type cacao.



QUALITY PROCESS

Quality, checked at the source

From farm to shipment

Four checks on each lot before it ships to a maker.

01

Fermentation

Monitored at the source.

02

Sun-drying

Beans are sun-dried to a target moisture level.

03

Lab testing

Moisture and cadmium testing, plus a cut test.

04

Traceability

Lot-level records from farm to shipment, checked by an auditor on the ground.

FOR CHOCOLATE MAKERS

How we work with makers

Samples first

Taste and test before you commit.

Small, traceable lots

Lots sized for craft makers, with lot-level records.

Clean import

OFAC screening, FDA prior notice and customs handled before anything ships.



WHAT'S NEXT

Macanao Cacao chocolate bars

Our own Venezuelan-origin bars, made from the beans we source.

Coming soon. Join the waitlist on our site.

Packaging concept



Request sample info

SAMPLES FIRST, THEN SMALL LOTS

- Web: https://vectordesigngroup.github.io/macanao-cacao-site/
- Email: coming soon
- Based in Gainesville, FL and Margarita Island, Venezuela